



ULAB

UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS
BANGLADESH

**Topic: Understanding Intercultural Communication-A Bangladeshi Student's Perspective
on the UK and Japan**

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Course Code: MSJ 2241

Course Title: Interpersonal and Intercultural Communication

Section: 01

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Culture and how we express it: Culture is the collection of shared convictions, traditions, values, behaviours, and fabric objects that characterize a gathering of individuals. It is passed down through eras and reflects the personality and way of life of a society. Here's how culture is expressed in different shapes:

- **Values:** These are the ethical standards that direct a society's behaviour, such as genuineness, regard, and correspondence. Values offer assistance shaping laws and social standards.
- **Food and Drink:** The sorts of nourishment individuals eat and how they plan and devour them reflect their culture. This consolidates ordinary dishes, dietary propensities, and food-related traditions.
- **The Arts:** Craftsmanship shapes like portray, music, move, and writing express imagination and the passionate, otherworldly, and authentic encounters of a culture.
- **Tools and Objects:** The apparatuses and objects individuals utilize for everyday errands, such as clothing, innovation, and engineering, are impacted by culture and serve utilitarian and typical purposes.
- **Techniques and Skills:** The strategies or aptitudes required for make, industry, and development are socially particular and pass down mastery over eras.
- **Traditions and Rituals:** These are traditions and ceremonies practiced frequently, like occasions, celebrations, and customs of section, that fortify social personality.
- **Language:** Dialect could be a key medium for communication, communicating considerations, feelings, and social subtleties.
- **Knowledge and Stories:** Stories and information, passed through eras, protect history, shrewdness, and ethical lessons.
- **Greater Community:** A sense of having a place to a more extensive community, counting values of participation, regard, and collective duty, characterizes how individuals associated and back each other.

Primary Barriers: Intercultural communication faces a few key obstructions:

- **Ethnocentrism:** Ethnocentrism leads us to judge others through our claim social focal point, frequently making an "us versus them" attitude.
- **Stereotyping:** Stereotyping decreases people to clichés, disregarding their uniqueness.
- **Psychological Barriers:** Psychological barriers emerge when adjusting to another culture feels unnatural or inauthentic.

- **Language Barriers:** Language barriers make disparity in worldwide groups, restricting interest and influencing discernment of competence.
- **Geographical Distance:** Geographical distance in virtual groups prevents relationship-building and comprehensive collaboration.
- **Conflicting Values:** Conflicting values, regularly covered up underneath behaviours, cause misconception when distinctive social standards clash.

Overcoming these obstructions requires sympathy, mindfulness, and flexibility in different situations.

How important is it to develop Intercultural Communication skills: Developing intercultural communication aptitudes is fundamental in today's associated world. As we work, travel, and associate with individuals from distinctive societies, the capacity to get it and communicate deferentially gets to be vital. These abilities offer assistance us dodge mistaken assumptions, construct belief, and work way better in differing groups. They, too, open entryways to modern viewpoints, companionship, and openings. Whether in commerce, instruction, or way of life, strong intercultural communication develops consolidation and cooperation. It permits us to explore contrasts with sympathy and certainty, making us more successful and aware worldwide citizens. In brief, it is a key aptitude for victory in a multicultural world.

Problem A: Moving from Bangladesh to the UK can be a life-changing encounter, but it moreover brings a few social challenges. One of the major obstacles is ethnocentrism, where people judge another culture based on their claim social values. For illustration, a Bangladeshi might discover it difficult to get it why individuals within the UK are more individualistic, whereas the British might confuse the warmth and casualness of Bangladeshi social interaction as meddling. This makes mistaken assumptions in both individual and proficient settings.

Another boundary is the distinction in communication styles. In Bangladesh, roundabout communication and regard for progression (a high-context culture) are common, particularly in formal circumstances. In differentiate, the UK takes after a more coordinate communication fashion and values individual space and time management (a low-context culture). This will lead to disarray or error amid discussions, such as considering somebody is inconsiderate fair since they are being clear.

To address these challenges, it is critical to hone cultural relativism—the thought that no culture is predominant to another, and behaviours should be caught on inside their social setting. For instance, within the UK, calling instructors or seniors by them to begin with names might feel ill-

bred to somebody from Bangladesh, but within the British setting, it is a sign of balance and openness.

The perfect state of intercultural and cross-cultural communication ought to be based on Cultural Intelligence (CQ)—the capacity to adjust and work effectively in totally different social settings. Concurring to Earley and Ang (2003), Cultural Intelligence includes four components: cognitive (information of social standards), motivational (intrigued in learning approximately unused societies), behavioural (adjusting activities appropriately), and metacognitive (considering around social intelligence and altering).

To be genuinely facilitated, both parties must be open-minded and willing to memorize. For Bangladeshi moving to the UK, this implies being inquisitive, watching British traditions (like lining, promptness, and protection), and adjusting consciously without losing one's character. Meanwhile, locals ought to attempt to get it the newcomer's foundation, such as the significance of community and religion in Bangladeshi life.

In outline, moving from Bangladesh to the UK includes exploring social contrasts and overcoming obstructions like ethnocentrism and communication crevices. Practicing cultural relativism and creating social insights can lead to meaningful, respectful intelligence between societies.

Problem B: Cultural differences shape how individuals communicate, work, and live. Comparing Bangladeshi culture with that of Japan reveals key resemblances and contrasts, particularly in communication styles, social values, and traditions. Understanding these contrasts is principal for effective intercultural communication in a globalized world. Bangladesh and Japan are both Asian countries with well off histories and strong social identities. Be that as it may, their cultures differ essentially due to components such as religion, economy, and social structure.

Bangladesh could be a South Asian nation with a Muslim-majority populace, where religion plays a central part in existence. In contrast, Japan, found in East Asia, is overwhelmingly affected by Shinto and Buddhist methods of insight, with a mainstream and more collectivist viewpoint. In terms of social behaviour, Bangladeshi culture tends to be expressive, warm, and relationship oriented. Individuals frequently lock into an individual intuitive and utilize motions or enthusiastic expressions amid discussions. In differentiate, Japanese culture values unobtrusiveness, limitation, and agreement. Communication is frequently roundabout, and individuals incline toward nuance over showdown. For illustration, in Bangladesh, a visitor is warmly welcomed with nourishment and individual consideration, whereas in Japan, neighbourliness is formal and cantered on conscious separation and behaviour.

These contrasts make intercultural communication critical. Misunderstandings can emerge when people from diverse societies translate behaviours, signals, or words in an unexpected way. For occasion, a Bangladeshi individual might consider a Japanese colleague cold or hostile due to their calm temper, whereas the Japanese person may see the Bangladeshi as excessively casual or

meddlesome. Intercultural communication grants people to bridge this cleft, developing shared understanding and respect.

Geert Hofstede's six dimensions of culture offer a valuable system to analyse these cultural differences:

1. Power Distance Index: Bangladesh scores tall on control separate, meaning that pecking order is regarded, and specialist is once in a while addressed. Japan incorporates a direct score, adjusting regard for specialist with a sense of bunch agreement.

2. Individualism Versus Collectivism: Both societies are collectivist, but Japan appears this through bunch concordance and devotion to organizations, whereas Bangladesh emphasizes family ties and devout community.

3. Masculinity Versus Femininity: Japan scores tall in masculinity, esteeming competition, achievement, and triumph. Bangladesh inclines somewhat toward a female culture, where caring for others and quality of life is emphasized more than ambition.

4. Uncertainty Avoidance Index: Japan contains an exceptionally tall score, demonstrating an inclination for rules, arranging, and consistency. Bangladeshi society too inclines toward a few structures but is for the most part more versatile to equivocalness.

5. Long- Versus Short-Term Orientation: Japan is long-term orchestrated, centring on tirelessness and future rewards. Bangladesh is more short-term situated, with solid regard for conventions and social commitments.

6. Indulgence Versus Restraint: Bangladesh inclines toward limitation, with restricted accentuation on recreation and delight. Japan too tends toward restriction, emphasizing obligation and self-control.

Understanding these measurements makes a difference in recognizing how individuals from diverse societies think and carry on. For case, a Japanese chief working with a Bangladeshi group ought to recognize the significance of individual connections and devout observances. So also, a Bangladeshi representative in Japan ought to get it the backhanded communication fashion and bunch concordance anticipated in Japanese work environments.

In conclusion, whereas both Bangladesh and Japan share collectivist values, their communication styles and social needs contrast. Intercultural communication, guided by systems like Hofstede's, is key to building fruitful connections over social boundaries.

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